Portfolio Kanban & Investment Mix

Limit how many big initiatives run at once, decide with a lean business case, and keep investment balanced.

Lead the Organisation · Lean Portfolio Management · Limit Portfolio WIP · Stop Starting, Start Finishing

PORTFOLIO _____

DATE _____

1 Portfolio Kanban

ONE STICKY PER INITIATIVE · PULL, DON'T PUSH

Funnel

Every new idea lands here

Exit when: _____

Initiatives

Reviewing

Worth a closer look?

WIP limit: _____

Exit when: _____

Initiatives

Analysing

Lean business case

WIP limit: _____

Exit when: _____

Initiatives

Ready

Approved, waiting for capacity

WIP limit: _____

Exit when: _____

Initiatives

Implementing

MVP first, then persevere or pivot

WIP limit: _____

Exit when: _____

Initiatives

Done

Outcome measured

Exit when: _____

Initiatives

2 Lean Business Case

ONE PAGE PER INITIATIVE IN ANALYSING

Initiative: _____

Problem or opportunity: _____

Hypothesis

We believe… _____

will result in… _____

We'll know when… _____

Smallest version (MVP): _____

Cost range: _____ Cost of delay: ☐ High ☐ Medium ☐ Low

Go / no-go criteria: _____

Decision: ☐ Go to Ready ☐ Not now ☐ Stop

3 Investment Mix

AGREE THE SPLIT UP FRONT

TYPE OF WORK	TARGET %	ACTUAL %
New bets		
Grow existing		
Run & maintain		
Tech debt & enablers		
Unplanned buffer		
Total = 100%		

Is the actual mix what we intended?

4 Portfolio Review

Review cadence: _____

Decision forum: _____

- ☐ WIP limits respected
- ☐ Stop something to start something
- ☐ Funding checked against outcomes
- ☐ Done items had their outcome measured
- ☐ Mix compared with the target

Next review: _____

"What would we stop to make room for this?"

"Which initiative, if it were the only one, would we finish first?"

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